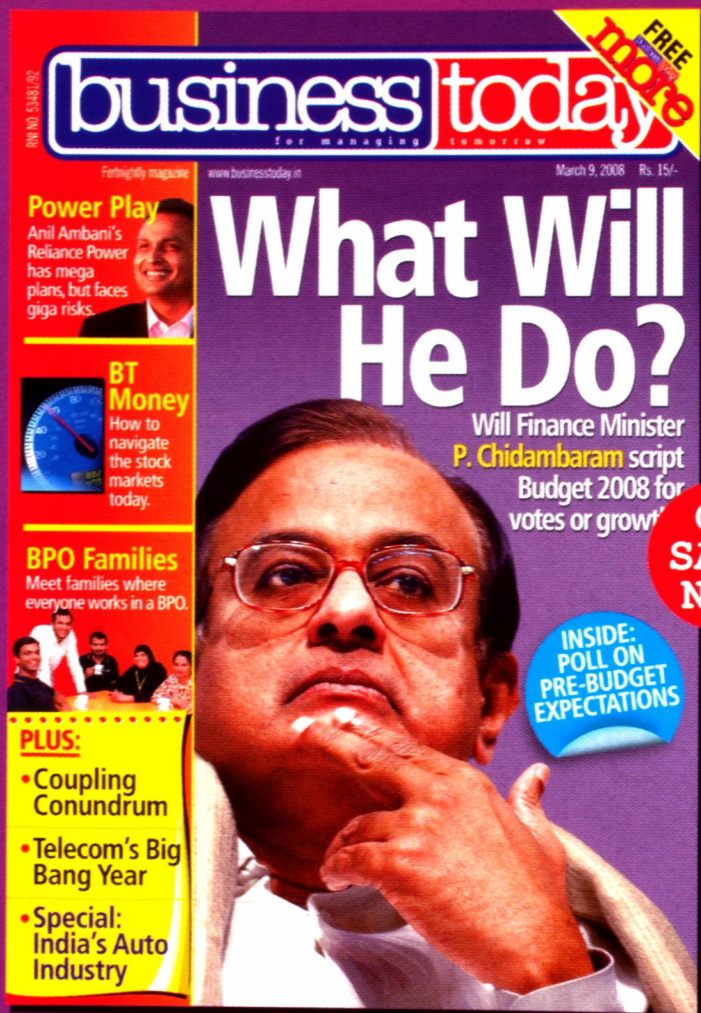


Chidambaram's Tightrope Walk



It's that time of the year again, when all eyes are glued on the Finance Minister for a hint on what he may have up his sleeves on February 29, when he presents the fifth, and last, Budget of this UPA government. The economy is critically poised; it is slowing down, foreign investors have turned wary and the General Elections are due next year. So, will he script Budget 2008 for votes or growth?

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No. 1 as per IRS 2007 R1 & R2 and NRS 2006 (Paid & Claimed Readership)

